2 A steel sphere of mass 0.29 kg is suspended in equilibrium from a vertical spring. The centre of the sphere is 8.5 cm from the top of the spring, as shown in Fig. 2.1.

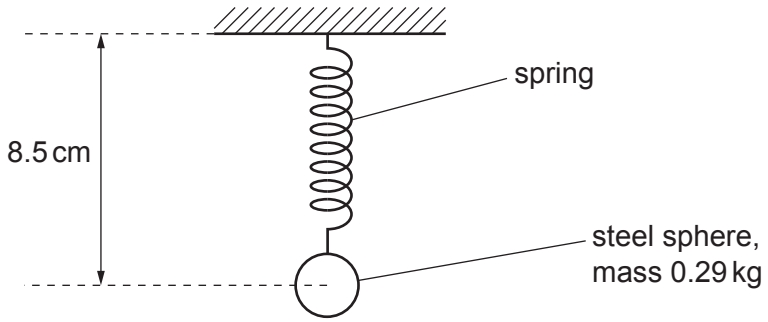


Fig. 2.1

The sphere is now set in motion so that it is moving in a horizontal circle at constant speed, as shown in Fig. 2.2.

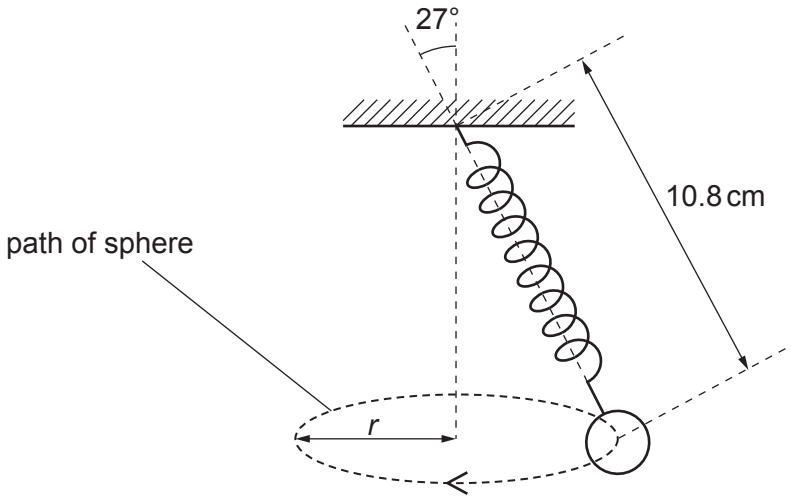


Fig. 2.2

The distance from the centre of the sphere to the top of the spring is now 10.8 cm.

(a) Explain, with reference to the forces acting on the sphere, why the length of the spring in Fig. 2.2 is greater than in Fig. 2.1.

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

(b) The angle between the linear axis of the spring and the vertical is 27°.

(i) Show that the radius r of the circle is 4.9 cm.

[1]

(ii) Show that the tension in the spring is 3.2 N.

[2]

(iii) The spring obeys Hooke's law.

Calculate the spring constant, in N cm^{-1}, of the spring.

spring constant = ... N cm^{-1} [2]

(c) **(i)** Use the information in **(b)** to determine the centripetal acceleration of the sphere.

centripetal acceleration = ... m s^{-2} [2]

(ii) Calculate the period of the circular motion of the sphere.

period = ... s [2]

[Total: 12]